

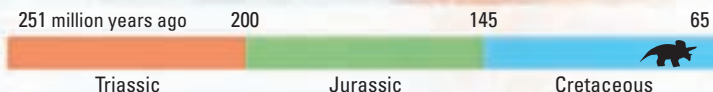
Triceratops

As heavy as a 10-ton truck, *Triceratops* was built like a huge rhinoceros. It gets its name (“three-horned face”) from the short nose horn and two longer brow horns. *Triceratops* used its horns and frills like deers use their antlers—to attract mates.

BATTLE SCARS

Bite marks left by the ferocious *Tyrannosaurus* on some *Triceratops* skulls suggest there were fierce clashes between the two species millions of years ago.

One *Triceratops* even seems to have had a brow horn snapped off.



Brow horn over
3 ft (1 m) long

Single row of teeth on
each side of lower jaw

Triceratops

try-SERRA-tops

- **When** 70–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** N. America
- **Habitat** Woodland
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Forest plants

Triceratops's neck was probably quite flexible, helping it to feed not only on tree leaves but also on low-growing plants. Its powerful parrotlike beak helped it pluck tough forest vegetation, such as palms, ferns, and cycads. Its teeth were like scissors—shredding and snipping the plants.